

ISSUE

No
XIII

17 AUGUST 25, 2026

DIGITAL EDITION • 4 EDITORIALS

TODAY'S EDITORIALS

"IF YOU DON'T LIKE TO READ,
YOU HAVEN'T FOUND THE RIGHT EDITORIALS."



Daily 1 – 4
Latest Editorials



The Hindu,
The Indian Express etc.



Important Vocab
Highlighted in Article



Higher Level
Vocabulary List (C1 & C2)



ONE STEP
AHEAD
EVERY DAY



RELEVANT
EDITORIALS
Handpicked Daily



VOCABULARY
LIST
Multiple Synonyms,
Tone & Part of
Speech



SMARTER
PREPARATION
Better
Understanding



STRONGER
RESULTS
Achieve Your Goal

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ISSUE

No

XIII

“

No. I can survive well enough on my own—if given the proper reading material.

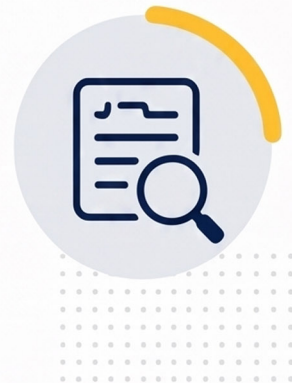
-SARAH J. MAAS



STAY INFORMED.
STAT AHEAD.
SUCCEED.

AUGUST 25, 2026

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Handpicked Daily



VOCABULARY
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Invisible actors: On bulk applications, voter name deletion

“The Election Commission must urgently curb fraudulent bulk deletions to protect democratic franchise.”

August 25, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The Election Commission of India (ECI)'s Special Intensive **Revision**¹ (SIR) of electoral rolls has seen allegations of bulk filing of applications seeking to delete voters' names from draft lists using Form 7 in Rajasthan, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh and, more recently Uttarakhand. Ground reports by The Hindu from Karnataka, Rajasthan and Gujarat noted that these forms were often filed in bulk **fraudulently**⁴ using names of people who were unaware of the filing. In several instances, hundreds of objections were filed under a single person's name. Form 7 is filed to **object to**⁵ an existing name — or to request its deletion — on the electoral rolls for reasons such as death, shifting, or **ineligibility**⁶. The ECI's Booth Level Officer or the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) has to conduct an inquiry on the application and issue a notice to the voter before taking any action. While Booth Level Agents (BLA) of political parties can file up to 10 Form 7s a day, totalling 30, there is no limit on how many forms an individual registered as a voter from the same **constituency**⁷ can submit. To prevent misuse, the ECI has said that if a person files more than five objections, it will trigger a **mandatory**⁸ review by the ERO to ensure the **legitimacy**⁹ of the claims.

The Opposition parties have alleged that the form was being misused through “**systemic**¹⁰ and **coordinated**¹¹ efforts” to delete names of eligible voters and **embolden**¹² the BJP's efforts to wrongfully gain electoral advantage. In the case of Uttarakhand, the Congress has alleged that the manner in which the bulk forms were submitted online pointed to “institutional” access being granted to some in the process. These parties have also sent delegations and submitted representations to the ECI. What is important to note is that in most cases, voters were unaware that applications for deletion of their names had been filed at all, leaving it to workers of political parties active in the **constituency**⁷ to bring it to their notice. According to ECI data, for the third phase of the SIR covering 16 States/three Union Territories there are 3,42,409 BLAs of political parties for an **electorate**¹⁶ of 36,73,87,831 or one BLA for approximately 1,073 voters. These numbers include agents from ruling and Opposition parties. In such a situation, it is **incumbent upon**¹⁷ the ECI to **step in**¹⁸ and protect the voting rights of an individual rather than leave it to the **grassroot**¹⁹ strength of political parties. The ECI should thus take immediate steps to address this concern. **Abnormal**²⁰ patterns should be investigated and the process should be monitored, with a uniform, country-wide Standard Operating Procedure, requiring verification of identity and **constituency**⁷ of the objector and the following of **due process**²¹ before any elector is deleted **pursuant to**²² a Form 7.

Source: The Hindu

Date: 2026-08-25

VOCABULARY 101

01 Revision update संशोधन / पुनरीक्षण	Noun
02 Electoral roll voter list मतदाता सूची	Noun
03 Allegation accusation आरोप	Noun
04 Fraudulently dishonestly धोखे से / कपटपूर्णक	Adverb
05 Object to oppose आपत्ति उठाना	Verb
06 Ineligibility unfitness अयोग्यता	Noun
07 Constituency voting area निर्वाचन क्षेत्र	Noun
08 Mandatory compulsory अनिवार्य / बाध्यकारी	Adjective
09 Legitimacy validity वैधता / औचित्य	Noun
10 Systemic widespread व्यवस्थगत / प्रणालीगत	Adjective
11 Coordinated organised समन्वित	Adjective
12 Embolden encourage हौसला बढ़ाना / बढ़ावा देना	Verb
13 Delegation envoy group प्रतिनिधिमंडल	Noun
14 Representation formal petition औपचारिक प्रतिवेदन / अर्जी	Noun
15 Bring to notice inform संज्ञान में लाना	Verb
16 Electorate voters मतदाता वर्ग	Noun
17 Incumbent upon binding on पर अनिवार्य होना / दायित्व होना	Adjective
18 Step in intervene हस्तक्षेप करना	Verb
19 Grassroot community-level जमीनी स्तर का	Adjective
20 Abnormal irregular असामान्य / अनियमित	Adjective
21 Due process legal fairness उचित कानूनी प्रक्रिया	Noun
22 Pursuant to in accordance with के अनुसार / के अनुपालन में	Preposition

DEEP DIVE

Idioms & applied grammar rules

Open Vocab Lab (P. 4) ...

EXECUTIVE PERSPECTIVE

EDITORIAL STANCE

CRITICAL

"pointing out flaws"

The author adopts a critical and watchful tone regarding the vulnerability of electoral rolls to mass fraudulent deletions via Form 7. The editorial argues that the Election Commission of India cannot leave vigilance to political party workers and must enforce strict, uniform procedural safeguards. The piece concludes with an urgent call for systemic standard operating procedures to uphold voter rights.

01	Revision NOUN NEUTRAL	 संशोधन / पुनरीक्षण The act of examining something again to alter, update, or correct it.	 MEMORY HOOK Re + vision = looking at something again to correct or update it.	SYNONYMS • amendment • modification • re-examination	ANTONYMS • preservation • stagnation • fixity
02	Allegation NOUN NEGATIVE	 आरोप A formal claim or assertion that someone has done something illegal or wrong, made without proof.	 MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'alligator' (alligator) — an untamed charge made against someone without instant proof.	SYNONYMS • assertion • charge • accusation	ANTONYMS • exoneration • vindication • acquittal
03	Fraudulently ADVERB NEGATIVE	 धोखे से / कपटपूर्वक In a way that involves deception, cheating, or breach of law for personal or unfair gain.	 MEMORY HOOK Fraud + ly = acting like a fraud or deceiver.	SYNONYMS • deceitfully • dishonourably • duplicitously	ANTONYMS • honestly • lawfully • transparently
04	Mandatory ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	 अनिवार्य / बाध्यकारी Required by law, rule, or official decree; not optional.	 MEMORY HOOK Command -> Mandate -> Mandatory (ordered by law).	SYNONYMS • obligatory • compulsory • statutory	ANTONYMS • discretionary • optional • voluntary

FIXED PREPOSITIONS • Object to (आपत्ति उठाना) To express disapproval of or challenge something formally. • Incumbent upon (पर अनिवार्य होना / दायित्व होना) Necessary for someone as a duty or responsibility. • Pursuant to (के अनुसार / के अनुपालन में) In accordance with or in execution of a law, rule, or official order. • Coordinated (समन्वित) Planned and executed harmoniously across different people or entities. • Grassroot (जमीनी स्तर का) Operating at or involving the most basic level of society or ordinary citizens.	PHRASAL VERBS • Step in (हस्तक्षेप करना) To become involved in a difficult situation in order to help or resolve it. • Systemic (व्यवस्थायुक्त / प्रणालीगत) Relating to or affecting an entire system rather than individual parts. • Representation (औपचारिक प्रतिवेदन / अर्जी) A formal statement of reasons, allegations, or grievances made to an...	ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS • Ineligibility (अयोग्यता) The state of not having the necessary qualifications, legal rights, or condition... • Constituency (निर्वाचन क्षेत्र) A geographical area or body of voters represented by an elected legislative... • Delegation (प्रतिनिधिमंडल) A group of representatives or deputies chosen to represent an organisation or... • Electorate (मतदाता वर्ग) All the people in a country or area who are entitled to vote in an election. • Legitimacy (वैधता / औचित्य) Conformity to the law, established rules, or accepted standards of authenticity. • Embolden (हौसला बढ़ाना / बढ़ावा देना) To give someone the courage or confidence to do something or to behave... • Abnormal (असामान्य / अनियमित) Deviating noticeably from what is normal, standard, or expected.	IDIOMS & PHRASES • Electoral roll (मतदाता सूची) An official register containing the names of all citizens entitled to vote in an... • Bring to notice (संज्ञान में लाना) To make someone aware of an important fact or situation. • Due process (उचित कानूनी प्रक्रिया) Fair treatment through the normal judicial or administrative procedures...
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STUDY TIP: Note the connotation and fixed prepositions when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

Perfect host: On India as host of the 2026 BWF World Championships

“ India demonstrates exemplary hosting prowess whilst French shuttlers break Asian dominance and home athletes encounter mixed fortunes.

17 August 25, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The 2026 BWF World Championships in New Delhi marked the rise of France as an on-court force and of India as a capable host. Alex Lanier’s **triumph**¹ in singles, and Thom Gicquel and Delphine Delrue’s in mixed doubles, were the first golds in France’s history. It was just over three months ago that the European nation finished a worthy **runner-up**² to China in the Thomas Cup, the **de facto**³ World Cup in badminton. The Worlds success has established France as a serious **contender**⁴ in a sport otherwise dominated by Asian countries. In fact, Lanier is just the third non-Asian this century — after Spain’s Carolina Marin and Denmark’s Viktor Axelsen — to win the singles gold at the World Championships. The 21-year-old did that at a spruced-up Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, which was **in the dock**⁶ earlier in January when pigeons and monkeys intruded into the arena during the India Open. The massive **facelift**⁸ ensured that the **marquee**⁹ event’s return to India after 17 years would be long remembered. An Se-Young will also go back with happy memories after reclaiming the women’s singles crown from three-time **titlist**¹¹ Akane Yamaguchi. The victory extended the 24-year-old **reigning**¹² Olympic champion’s **stellar**¹³ 2026, during which she has won an Uber Cup gold medal, and the individual and team trophies at the Badminton Asia Championships.

For India, the competition was the 12th **straight**¹⁴ edition where it secured at least one medal, with Gayatri Gopichand and Treesa Jolly bagging a bronze in women’s doubles. The performance is the latest in a series of good outcomes for Indian badminton after an ordinary 2025, where Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty’s World Championships doubles bronze was the best result. This year, Lakshya Sen reached the All England Open final, and Ayush Shetty at the Badminton Asia Championships. P.V. Sindhu’s victory at the Japan Open Super 750 last month was only her second Tour title in the last four years, and there were also triumphs for Satwiksairaj and Chirag at Singapore Open Super 750, and for Devika Sihag, Tanvi Sharma and Ashmita Chaliha at the Super 300 level. Yet, the feeling is **unmistakable**¹⁶ that India should have done better at a home World Championships, with Lakshya’s second-round defeat to the **unheralded**¹⁷ American teenager Garret Tan the most disappointing. There is no questioning the 25-year-old’s capability; he is a World Championships bronze medallist, a two-time All England finalist and finished an **agonising**¹⁸ fourth at the Paris 2024 Olympics. But no Indian men’s singles player has won an **elite**¹⁹ BWF Super 1000-level title since K. Srikanth in 2017. A swift end to this **drought**²⁰ is essential for the overall health of the sport.

Source: The Hindu

Date: 2026-08-25

VOCABULARY 101

01	Triumph victory	महान विजय	Noun
02	Runner-up second place	उपविजेता	Noun
03	De facto actual	वास्तविक (बिना औपचारिक घोषणा के)	Adjective
04	Contender competitor	दावेदार / प्रतिद्वंद्वी	Noun
05	Spruce up tidy up	सजाना / संवारना	Verb
06	In the dock under scrutiny	कचरे में / अलोचना के घेरे में	Phrase
07	Intrude into trespass upon	अनाधिकार प्रवेश करना	Verb
08	Facelift renovation	कायाकल्प / नवीनीकरण	Noun
09	Marquee headline	प्रमुख / सर्वोत्कृष्ट	Adjective
10	Reclaim recover	पुनः प्राप्त करना	Verb
11	Titlist champion	खिताबधारी / विजेता	Noun
12	Reigning current	वर्तमान (विजेता)	Adjective
13	Stellar exceptional	शानदार / उत्कृष्ट	Adjective
14	Straight consecutive	लगातार / निरंतर	Adjective
15	Bag secure	हासिल करना / जीतना	Verb
16	Unmistakable distinct	स्पष्ट / असंदिग्ध	Adjective
17	Unheralded unrecognised	अनाम / पूर्वप्रचारित न किया गया	Adjective
18	Agonising painful	कष्टदायी / दुखद	Adjective
19	Elite top-tier	उत्कृष्ट / शीर्षस्थ	Adjective
20	Drought dry spell	लंबा सूखा / अभाव का दौर	Noun

DEEP DIVE

Mnemonics & applied grammar rules

Open Vocab Lab (P. 6)

EXECUTIVE PERSPECTIVE

EDITORIAL STANCE

APPRECIATIVE YET EVALUATIVE

"praising while critically assessing"

The author adopts an appreciative yet evaluative tone to commend India's successful logistical turnaround as host of the 2026 BWF World Championships and highlights France's historic sporting breakthrough. However, the tone shifts to critical appraisal when examining India's on-court campaign, lamenting the home team's inability to capitalise fully on familiar conditions. The editorial concludes with a pragmatic call for Indian men's badminton to decisively end its prolonged top-tier title drought.

01	Triumph NOUN POSITIVE	महान विजय A great victory, achievement, or notable success against stiff competition.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'try and jump' — when you win a big tournament, you try your best and jump with joy.	SYNONYMS • conquest • mastery • supremacy	ANTONYMS • defeat • catastrophe • subjugation
02	Marquee ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	प्रमुख / सर्वोत्कृष्ट Pre-eminent, most important, or commanding the greatest public attention.	MEMORY HOOK The giant brightly-lit marquee above a theatre showcases only the top-billing shows.	SYNONYMS • flagship • premier • paramount	ANTONYMS • minor • inconsequential • subsidiary
03	Reclaim VERB POSITIVE	पुनः प्राप्त करना To retrieve or win back the possession or control of something previously lost.	MEMORY HOOK Re (again) + claim (demand) = claiming back what once belonged to you.	SYNONYMS • regain • recapture • retrieve	ANTONYMS • forfeit • surrender • relinquish
04	Reigning ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	वर्तमान (विजेता) Currently holding a title, championship, or supreme office.	MEMORY HOOK Like a king 'reigning' on the throne, a reigning champion sits at the top right now.	SYNONYMS • incumbent • ruling • prevailing	ANTONYMS • former • deposed • past

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

- **Intrude into** (अनधिकार प्रवेश करना)
To enter a place, situation, or environment uninvited, disrupting the...
- **Bag** (हासिल करना / जीतना)
To succeed in securing, winning, or obtaining something desirable.

PHRASAL VERBS

- **Spruce up** (सजाना / संवारना)
To make someone or something look clean, neat, smart, and revitalised.
- **Straight** (लगातार / निरंतर)
Unbroken in series; occurring one after another without interruption.
- **Agonising** (कष्टदायी / दुःखद)
Causing immense mental anguish, distress, or acute disappointment.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

- **Runner-up** (उपविजेता)
A competitor or team that finishes in second place in a contest or...
- **Contender** (दावेदार / प्रतिद्वंद्वी)
A person, group, or nation that competes with a serious chance of winning a title...
- **Facelift** (कायाकल्प / नवीनीकरण)
A comprehensive overhaul or redesign intended to restore or enhance...
- **Titlist** (खिताबधारी / विजेता)
A competitor who holds a championship title in sports.
- **Unheralded** (अनाम / पूर्वप्रचारित न किया गया)
Not previously announced, acknowledged, or celebrated in advance.
- **Elite** (उत्कृष्ट / शीर्षस्थ)
Representing the highest class, caliber, or highest tier within a hierarchy.
- **Stellar** (शानदार / उत्कृष्ट)
Exceptionally good, outstanding, or of the highest quality.
- **Unmistakable** (स्पष्ट / असंदिग्ध)
Clearly evident and unable to be mistaken for anything else.

IDIOMS & PHRASES

- **In the dock** (कटघरे में / आलोचना के घेरे में)
Being subjected to rigorous public scrutiny, trial, criticism, or blame.
- **Drought** (लंबा सूखा / अभाव का दौर)
A prolonged, frustrating period of absence or lack of victories and...

FOREIGN WORDS

- **De facto** (वास्तविक (बिना औपचारिक घोषणा के))
Existing in fact or reality, whether legally recognised or officially ordained or not.



STUDY TIP: Note the connotation and fixed prepositions when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

It is wrong to cancel Telangana CM's US visit

“Blocking an Opposition leader's foreign visit reflects partisan insecurity and harms federal cooperation.”

August 25, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Instead of heading to Boston as planned on Sunday, Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy **abruptly**¹ flew back to India from London — he was denied permission by the Ministry of External Affairs for the US tour, which led to the cancellation of the **second leg**² of his foreign trip. Undoubtedly, denying permission lay in the MEA's **remit**³. Before it accords political clearance, the visits of chief ministers and other dignitaries are assessed by the ministry for criteria such as the “purpose” and “level” of scheduled meetings. And yet, it is **unseemly**⁶ that the MEA should **weaponise**⁷ the rulebook's **small print**⁸ to **cut short**⁹ CM Reddy's trip. Apparently, the CM's **itinerary**¹⁰ included possible meetings with New York City mayor Zohran Mamdani and US Vice President J D Vance — while the NYC mayor is seen at some levels below the Telangana CM, a meeting with the US Vice President did not fit the trip's stated purpose, which was to attract investment into Telangana, including educational partnerships. This is a narrow-minded approach that does not **behave**¹¹ the external affairs ministry of a country like India, which prides itself on its growing confidence on the world stage, and on building global knowledge hubs like Hyderabad. Moreover, by curtailing an Opposition chief minister's foreign trip, the government looks small and **heavy-handed**¹⁴, sending a **dispiriting**¹⁵ signal to the world — and within the country.

The denial of permission to CM Reddy can be seen as part of a **dismal**¹⁶ pattern of **antagonism**¹⁷, and the near breakdown of dialogue, between government and Opposition at home. This is so even as Reddy, the second CM of a newly carved out state, who began his career in the ABVP, has been seen to tweak the script — in the past, he has struck a note of **pragmatism**¹⁹ and **cordiality**²⁰ **vis-à-vis**²¹ the government of Narendra Modi. In the aftermath, the political **to-and-fro**²² has seen the recycling of tired and opaque spectres and prejudices — the BJP in Telangana has insinuated that the MEA decision was meant to **cut short**⁹ engagement with “anti-India” and/or “anti-BJP” elements, that are out to destabilise “national security”.

After Operation Sindoor in May 2025, the Modi government dispatched seven multi-party delegations, which included prominent leaders of the Opposition, to foreign capitals. They were tasked with making India's case to the world while projecting national unity. The subject, then, was terror, but the message was more generally heartening: That whatever be the political differences within, India's ruling establishment trusted and included the Opposition in its dealings with the world. CM Reddy's abbreviated trip now points to an unfortunate and unflattering **backsliding**²⁵.

Source: The Indian Express

Date: 2026-08-25

VOCABULARY 101

01 Abruptly suddenly	अचानक / एकाएक	Adverb
02 Second leg second stage	यात्रा का दूसरा चरण	Noun phrase
03 Remit jurisdiction	अधिकार क्षेत्र / कार्यक्षेत्र	Noun
04 Accord grant	प्रदान करना / सहमति देना	Verb
05 Dignitary VIP	प्रतिष्ठित व्यक्ति / उच्चाधिकारी	Noun
06 Unseemly improper	अनुचित / असोभनीय	Adjective
07 Weaponise exploit maliciously	हथियार की तरह इस्तेमाल करना	Verb
08 Small print hidden terms	छिपी हुई शर्तें / बारीक नियम	Noun phrase
09 Cut short terminate early	अचानक समाप्त कर देना	Phrasal verb
10 Itinerary travel plan	यात्रा-कार्यक्रम	Noun
11 Behove befit	शोभा देना / उचित होना	Verb
12 Pride oneself on take pride in	पर गर्व करना	Verb phrase
13 Curtail reduce	घटाना / कटौती करना	Verb
14 Heavy-handed overbearing	कठोर / निरंकुश	Adjective
15 Dispiriting discouraging	निराशाजनक / हतोत्साहित करने वाला	Adjective
16 Dismal gloomy	निराशाजनक / शोचनीय	Adjective
17 Antagonism hostility	शत्रुता / विरोध	Noun
18 Carve out create	तरास कर बनाना / अलग करना	Phrasal verb
19 Pragmatism practicality	व्यावहारिकता	Noun
20 Cordiality warmth	सौहार्द / आत्मीयता	Noun
21 Vis-à-vis in relation to	के संबंध में / के मुकाबले	Preposition
22 To-and-fro back-and-forth	आना-जाना / नोक-झोंक	Noun phrase
23 Spectre ghost	साया / भय की आशंका	Noun
24 Insinuate hint maliciously	इशारा करना / अप्रत्यक्ष रूप से दोष लगाना	Verb
25 Backsliding relapse	पतन / पूर्व की बुरी स्थिति में लौटना	Noun

DEEP DIVE

Mnemonics & applied grammar rules

Open Vocab Lab (P. 8)

EXECUTIVE PERSPECTIVE

EDITORIAL STANCE

CRITICAL

"disapproving and fault-finding"

The author adopts a critical tone towards the Union government for revoking diplomatic clearance for the Telangana Chief Minister's US visit. The editorial argues that exploiting procedural technicalities to curb an elected leader's international engagement signals petty partisanship and a breakdown in domestic political trust. In conclusion, the author asserts that such heavy-handed decisions damage India's democratic stature and reverse commendable precedents of cross-party cooperation.

01	Abruptly ADVERB NEGATIVE	 अचानक / एकाएक Suddenly and unexpectedly, often with a sense of unpleasantness or haste.	 MEMORY HOOK ABRUPT sounds like 'a disrupt' — happening unexpectedly and breaking the normal flow.	SYNONYMS • precipitously • unexpectedly • unceremoniously	ANTONYMS • gradually • progressively • smoothly
02	Remit NOUN NEUTRAL	 अधिकार क्षेत्र / कार्यक्षेत्र The scope of authority, responsibility, or area of jurisdiction assigned to a person or body.	 MEMORY HOOK RE + LIMIT = the limits within which an authority is permitted to make decisions.	SYNONYMS • purview • jurisdiction • mandate	ANTONYMS • powerlessness • proscription • exclusion
03	Accord VERB POSITIVE	 प्रदान करना / सहमति देना To grant, give, or bestow official sanction, status, or recognition upon someone.	 MEMORY HOOK Think of 'According to rules, permission was granted' — to accord is to grant or bestow.	SYNONYMS • confer • bestow • vouchsafe	ANTONYMS • withhold • deny • refuse
04	Unseemly ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	 अनुचित / अशोभनीय Not proper, appropriate, or suitable according to accepted standards of conduct.	 MEMORY HOOK UN + SEEMLY = not seeming right or appropriate for the occasion.	SYNONYMS • improper • indecorous • unbecoming	ANTONYMS • seemly • decorous • befitting

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

- Pride oneself on** (पर गर्व करना)
To feel deeply satisfied with oneself about a particular skill, status, or achievement.
- Curtail** (घटाना / कटौती करना)
To reduce in extent, duration, or quantity; to impose a restriction upon.
- Antagonism** (शत्रुता / विरोध)
Active hostility, opposition, or deep-seated mutual animosity.
- Insinuate** (इशारा करना / अप्रत्यक्ष रूप से दोष लगाना)
To suggest or hint at something bad or improper in an indirect, unpleasant way.

PHRASAL VERBS

- Cut short** (अचानक समाप्त कर देना)
To interrupt or stop something before its scheduled or expected completion.
- Carve out** (तराश कर बनाना / अलग करना)
To establish, separate, or create something through deliberate effort from.
- Behove** (शोभा देना / उचित होना)
To be appropriate, morally necessary, or proper for someone to do.
- Dismal** (निराशाजनक / शोचनीय)
Gloomy, depressing, or characterised by poor quality and lack of hope.
- Spectre** (साया / भय की आशंका)
Something widely feared as a possible unpleasant, dangerous, or haunting...

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

- Dignitary** (प्रतिष्ठित व्यक्ति / उच्चाधिकारी)
A person considered important because of high rank, high office, or government...
- Itinerary** (यात्रा-कार्यक्रम)
A planned route, schedule, or list of appointments for a journey.
- Pragmatism** (व्यावहारिकता)
An approach that evaluates theories or policies solely in terms of their practical...
- Weaponise** (हथियार की तरह इस्तेमाल करना)
To exploit or adapt a procedure, policy, or rule to gain a hostile political advantage.
- Dispiriting** (निराशाजनक / हतोत्साहित करने वाला)
Causing a loss of hope, enthusiasm, or confidence.
- Cordiality** (सौहार्द / आत्मीयता)
The quality of being warm, polite, and friendly in manner and tone.
- Backsliding** (फटन / पूर्व की बुरी स्थिति में लौटना)
A relapse into bad habits, worse behaviour, or lesser democratic...

IDIOMS & PHRASES

- Second leg** (यात्रा का दूसरा चरण)
The second distinct section or stage of a journey, competition, or multi-part...
- Small print** (छिपी हुई शर्तें / बारीक नियम)
Technical rules or restrictive conditions often overlooked because they are subtl...
- Heavy-handed** (कठोर / निरंकुश)
Using excessive force, authority, or clumsy severity without subtlety or tact.
- To-and-fro** (आना-जाना / नौक-झोंक)
Constant movement, exchange of arguments, or dispute back and forth...

FOREIGN WORDS

- Vis-à-vis** (के संबंध में / के मुकाबले)
In relation to; with regard to, or compared with.



STUDY TIP: Note the connotation and fixed prepositions when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

In saying no to Trump, Carney is doing the right thing

“Canada sets a firm precedent as middle powers push back against unilateral trade aggression.”

17 August 25, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

By instructing his negotiators to **walk away from**¹ trade talks with the US — reportedly over Washington’s last-minute demands — Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has drawn a red line against President Donald Trump’s **weaponisation**³ of tariffs. Canada’s economy is deeply **integrated with**⁴ that of its superpower neighbour, and Carney’s “**dollar-for-dollar**⁵” **retaliation**⁶ against Trump’s 50 per cent tariffs on around \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods will **inevitably**⁷ hurt businesses and workers on both sides of the border. Among other “unacceptable” demands, said PM Carney, Washington seeks to restrict Canada’s ability to pursue trade deals with other countries, which would **amount to**⁸ an **erosion**⁹ of Canadian **sovereignty**¹⁰. Elected to power not too long ago on a promise to **stand up to**¹¹ Trump’s threats, Carney has done the right thing by rejecting an unequal trade relationship. In doing so, he is also acting on his assessment at Davos seven months ago: The “**rules-based order**¹²”, he had said, “is **fading**¹³”.

The Trump tariffs **touch**¹⁴ products from Canadian wine and dairy to furniture, clothing, cement and hockey equipment. Should Carney **proceed with**¹⁵ Canada’s **retaliation**⁶ from September 8 onwards, there will be risks, both political and economic, for his country. But the popularity of the “Buy Canadian” campaign — an expression of **economic nationalism**¹⁶ **triggered by**¹⁷ Trump’s threats, including making Canada the 51st state of the US — has already shown that many Canadians support their government’s challenge to the US president. Carney will now have to convince them that the costs of **confrontation**¹⁸ are worth paying.

For the Canadian PM, the **showdown**¹⁹ with Trump is the clearest test yet of his **thesis**²⁰ that **middle powers**²¹ must **stand up to**¹¹ great powers and unite. Indeed, he has been busy securing deals in Asia and Europe, a **paradigm shift**²² away from Canada’s economic **dependence on**²³ the US so far. It is too early to say whether these new partnerships have the substance to **mitigate**²⁴ the pain that a **breakdown in**²⁵ US-Canada relations will cause. But Carney is doing something rather rare in the Trump era: A middle power is saying no to a superpower.

Source: The Indian Express

Date: 2026-08-25

VOCABULARY 101

01 Walk away from abandon छोड़कर चले जाना / वार्ता से हटना	Verb phrase
02 Draw a red line set a limit अंतिम सीमा तय करना / लक्ष्मण रेखा खींचना	Idiom
03 Weaponisation instrumentalisation हथियारीकरण	Noun
04 Integrated with combined with से एकीकृत / जुड़ा हुआ	Adjective + Preposition
05 Dollar-for-dollar strictly reciprocal समान मूल्य का / पाई-पाई का बदला	Adjective / Adverb
06 Retaliation counterattack प्रतिशोध / जवाबी कार्रवाई	Noun
07 Inevitably unavoidably अनिवार्य रूप से / अवश्यम्भावी तौर पर	Adverb
08 Amount to equal के बराबर होना / समतुल्य होना	Verb phrase
09 Erosion deterioration क्षरण / धीरे-धीरे नष्ट होना	Noun
10 Sovereignty autonomy संप्रभुता	Noun
11 Stand up to resist डटकर मुकाबला करना / विरोध करना	Verb phrase
12 Rules-based order international legal framework नियम-आधारित व्यवस्था	Noun phrase
13 Fading diminishing घुंघला पड़ता हुआ / क्षीण होता हुआ	Adjective
14 Touch affect प्रभावित करना / दायरे में लेना	Verb
15 Proceed with go ahead with आगे बढ़ना / जारी रखना	Verb + Preposition
16 Economic nationalism protectionism आर्थिक राष्ट्रवाद	Noun phrase
17 Triggered by caused by के द्वारा प्रेरित / से शुरू हुआ	Participle + Preposition
18 Confrontation clash टकराव / आमना-सामना	Noun
19 Showdown decisive contest निर्णायक मुकाबला / आर-पार की लड़ाई	Noun
20 Thesis proposition सिद्धांत / प्रतिपाद्य विषय	Noun
21 Middle powers secondary states मध्यम शक्तियाँ	Noun phrase
22 Paradigm shift fundamental change बुनियादी बदलाव / वैचारिक परिवर्तन	Noun phrase
23 Dependence on reliance on पर निर्भरता	Noun + Preposition
24 Mitigate lessen कम करना / शांत करना	Verb
25 Breakdown in collapse of में विफलता / टूटन	Noun + Preposition

DEEP DIVE

Mnemonics & applied grammar rules

Open Vocab Lab (P. 10) →

EDITORIAL STANCE

COMMENDATORY

"approving and supportive"

EXECUTIVE PERSPECTIVE

The author adopts a commendatory tone to endorse Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney's decisive refusal to submit to aggressive US trade demands. While acknowledging the inevitable economic costs and trade disruptions, the editorial argues that defending national sovereignty and diversifying alliances represent a necessary stand for middle powers against great-power coercion.

01	Weaponisation NOUN NEGATIVE	हथियारीकरण The act of adapting or exploiting something as a tool of attack, pressure, or coercive leverage.	MEMORY HOOK Turning regular tools or policies into 'weapons' of coercion.	SYNONYMS • exploitation • mobilisation • instrumentalisation	ANTONYMS • pacification • disarmament • neutralisation
02	Retaliation NOUN NEGATIVE	प्रतिशोध / जवाबी कार्रवाई Deliberate counteraction or reprisal undertaken in response to a harmful act.	MEMORY HOOK Re-TALI-ation: 'Tali' (clapping/hitting) back in response to an attack.	SYNONYMS • reprisal • counteraction • reciprocation	ANTONYMS • forgiveness • submission • tolerance
03	Inevitably ADVERB NEUTRAL	अनिवार्य रूप से / अवश्यम्भावी तौर पर In a manner that is completely unavoidable and certain to happen.	MEMORY HOOK In- (not) + Evitable (avoidable) = something you cannot avoid.	SYNONYMS • inescapably • unavoidably • inexorably	ANTONYMS • avoidably • preventably • uncertainly
04	Erosion NOUN NEGATIVE	क्षरण / धीरे-धीरे नष्ट होना The gradual diminution, weakening, or destruction of an asset, authority, or standard.	MEMORY HOOK Think of soil 'erosion' by water, wearing away solid ground bit by bit.	SYNONYMS • depletion • degradation • attenuation	ANTONYMS • strengthening • enhancement • consolidation

FIXED PREPOSITIONS Integrated with (से एकीकृत / जुड़ा हुआ) Closely interconnected, blended, or unified with another entity or system. Proceed with (आगे बढ़ना / जारी रखना) To carry out, continue, or move forward with a planned action or course of... Triggered by (के द्वारा प्रेरित / से शुरू हुआ) Set in motion, initiated, or provoked directly by a particular event or action. Dependence on (पर निर्भरता) The state of relying on or being controlled by someone or something else... Breakdown in (में विफलता / टूटन) A mechanical failure, disruption, or total collapse in a relationship, system, or... Confrontation (टकराव / आमना-सामना) A hostile, contentious, or argumentative meeting or situation between opposing... Mitigate (कम करना / शांत करना) To make something painful, harmful, or severe less intense or harsh.	PHRASAL VERBS Walk away from (छोड़कर चले जाना / वार्ता से हटना) To abandon or withdraw from a negotiation, agreement, or difficult... Amount to (के बराबर होना / समतुल्य होना) To be equivalent to or have the same overall practical outcome as something. Stand up to (डटकर मुकाबला करना / विरोध करना) To confront, oppose, or resist someone strong or aggressive with courage. Touch (प्रभावित करना / दायरे में लेना) To affect, impact, or encompass specific items, sectors, or individuals. Thesis (सिद्धांत / प्रतिपाद्य विषय) A central proposition, theory, or argument put forward and maintained...	ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS Sovereignty (संप्रभुता) The supreme and independent power of a state to govern its own affairs without... Economic nationalism (आर्थिक राष्ट्रवाद) An ideology and policy framework that prioritises domestic economic control,... Middle powers (मध्यम शक्तियाँ) Sovereign states that possess significant diplomatic and economic influence... Fading (धुंधला पड़ना हुआ / क्षीण होता हुआ) Gradually losing strength, distinctness, vitality, or relevance. Showdown (निर्णायक मुकाबला / आर-पार की लड़ाई) A final, decisive confrontation or contest that settles a long-standing dispute.	IDIOMS & PHRASES Draw a red line (अंतिम सीमा तय करना / लक्ष्मण रेखा खींचना) To set an inviolable limit or boundary beyond which compromise or behaviour... Dollar-for-dollar (समान मूल्य का / पाई-पाई का बदला) Matching the exact monetary amount or value in response; strictly equivalent an... Rules-based order (नियम-आधारित व्यवस्था) A system of international relations committed to shared agreements,... Paradigm shift (बुनियादी बदलाव / वैचारिक परिवर्तन) A fundamental and transformative change in an approach, policy, or...
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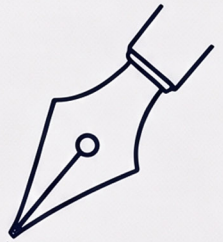
STUDY TIP: Note the connotation and fixed prepositions when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

**TODAY'S
EDITORIALS**

ONE STEP
AHEAD
EVERYDAY



THANK YOU!



“

FOR READING. FOR LEARNING.
FOR GROWING EVERY DAY.

We're really thrilled to keep working on this. We hope you'll continue supporting this effort until the very end. Most importantly, we hope each one of you achieves success and gets selected in your recruitment exam.

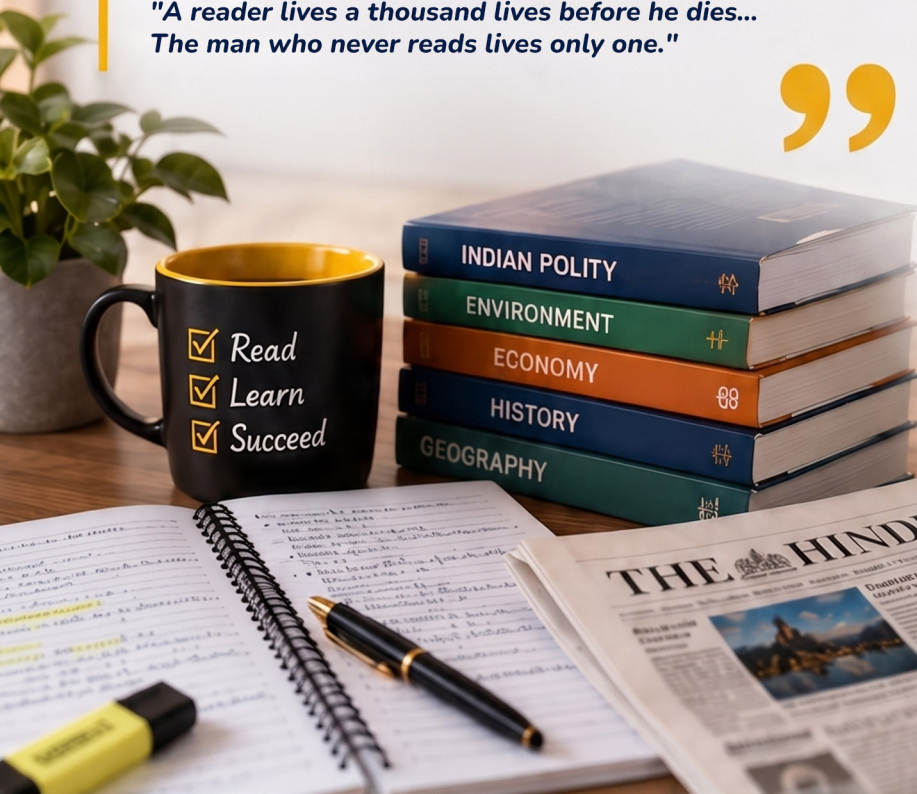


If you put in the necessary effort and stay consistent, your ambition of building a career in the public or private sector can certainly become a reality.

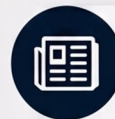
Just keep in mind one thing,

**"A reader lives a thousand lives before he dies...
The man who never reads lives only one."**

”



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